

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2017



Solution and marking.

Scoring: 1 point for each correct word. (Max 40)

- When two translations are possible, only credit unrepeated words.

a	masita / masāga kāpī cha.	4
b	Bindusita / Bindusāga ek baṭṭā churoṭ chaina.	6
c	Gitako śrīman cha.	3
d	Rameshki nātini cha.	3
e	timīsāga / timīsita das rupiy* chan? (*= a mixture of ã and ā)	5
f	Gharka tīnvatā koṭṭaharu chan.	4
g	parivārki nātini chaina.	3
h	timīsāga / timīsita miṭhāī chan?	4
i	Anilsita / Anilsāga s*co chaina. (*= a mixture of ã and ā)	4
j	masita / masāga pēnsila chaina.	4

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Commentary

Possession is expressed in Nepali with the possessed as subject, as though we said ‘A bike belongs to me’ instead of ‘I have a bike’. More precisely, the verb used is ‘be’, so a literal translation into English would be ‘A bike is (to) me’, where ‘to’ corresponds to the ending on the possessor noun, explained below. These suffixes are added to the possessor, which in these examples is either a name or a pronoun.

Suffix	explanation
-sita	Can be used interchangeably with – sāga. Both are used when the possessed is a small item that a speaker / person can carry with them, on their person, such as money, pens, cigarettes etc.
-sāga	See above.
-ko	Used when the possessed is too big to be carried by a person (such as houses or cars) or to refer to friends / family “belonging” to a person. The “ko” suffix is used when the possessed is masculine.
-ki	Used when the possession is too big to be carried by a person (such as houses or cars) or to refer to friends / family “belonging” to a person. The “ki” suffix is used when the possessed is feminine.
-ka	Used when the possession is too big to be carried by a person (such as houses or cars) or to refer to friends / family “belonging” to a person. The “ka” suffix is used for nouns (in possession) that are plural.